

IIT Madras honours Shrey Ramanujam with EFY Prize 2026

Presented annually at IIT Madras Institute Day since 2012, the EFY Prize 2026 was awarded to BS-MS Physics student Shrey Ramanujam during the institute's 67th Institute Day celebrations. Recognising outstanding academic performance, the award honours his 9.31 CGPA, as well as achievements in ultrafast optics, LIGO research, X-ray science, and international physics competitions.



Shrey Ramanujam receiving the EFY Prize 2026 from IIT Madras Director Prof. V. Kamakoti, with Chief Economic Adviser Dr V. Anantha Nageswaran looking on, at the 67th Institute Day ceremony held at IIT Madras

India weighs \$1 billion push for electric buses and trucks

India is considering incentives exceeding \$1 billion over 10 years to accelerate private adoption of electric buses and trucks. The proposed scheme, including financing support and credit guarantees, aims to reduce oil dependence, improve energy security, and curb pollution. Initially targeting 10,000 buses, it could eventually support 40,000-50,000 commercial electric vehicles.

Indian PCB firms demand 50% hike amid war

India's PCB manufacturers are seeking a 45-50% price hike from electronics brands as the West Asia conflict disrupts supplies and drives raw material costs up by as much as 150%. Resin shortages, longer lead times, and higher freight costs threaten localisation efforts. The industry is urging government support and stronger action against low-cost PCB imports.

India seeks preferential US tariffs in trade talks

India is seeking preferential tariff treatment from the US in ongoing bilateral trade negotiations, arguing its exporters must remain competitive with

rival nations. The talks are particularly significant for India's fast-growing electronics sector, which relies on stable market access. Both sides aim to conclude the first phase of a trade agreement by mid-July 2026.

India-Oman CEPA opens doors for electronics exporters

India's CEPA with Oman came into force on June 1, 2026, granting duty-free access to 99.38% of Indian exports. The pact is expected to benefit electronics, engineering goods and other sectors, with all electronics

categories receiving zero-duty access. It enhances opportunities for PLI-backed manufacturers, strengthens supply-chain integration.

BSNL revenue climbs to ₹250 billion

BSNL has increased annual revenue from ₹210 billion to ₹250 billion and improved EBITDA from ₹500 million to nearly ₹70 billion in two years, driven by network upgrades and operational reforms. The telecom operator deployed indigenous 4G across 100,000 towers, expanded

INTERNATIONAL news

SpaceX hits record \$1.77 trillion valuation in landmark IPO

SpaceX has achieved a record-breaking \$1.77 trillion valuation after pricing its IPO at \$135 per share, making it the largest public offering in US history. The company raised \$75 billion to fund Starlink expansion and AI data centres. Set to trade on Nasdaq under the symbol SPCX, the offering attracted exceptionally strong demand from institutional and retail investors.

US announces \$2 billion quantum computing push under CHIPS Act

The US Department of Commerce plans to provide more than \$2 billion in incentives to boost domestic quantum computing under the CHIPS and Science Act. IBM will receive \$1 billion for a quantum foundry, while GlobalFoundries gets \$375 million. The initiative supports multiple quantum technologies, strengthens manufacturing, and enhances US competitiveness and national security.

AMD commits £2 billion to boost UK's AI growth

AMD will invest up to £2 billion in the UK over five years to expand AI research, computing infrastructure, and workforce development. Announced at London Tech Week 2026, the initiative includes partnerships with universities, research institutions, and technology firms, supporting advanced AI systems, scientific research, and sovereign AI capabilities while strengthening the UK's innovation ecosystem.

French counter-drone startup Alta Ares raises €50 million in fresh funding

French counter-drone startup Alta Ares has raised €50 million to scale production of its AI-enabled interceptor drones and expand into Poland, Germany, and the US. Its systems, already deployed in Ukraine, the Middle East, and Asia, use AI, sensing technologies, and embedded electronics to counter drones, missiles, and glide bombs amid rising security concerns.

Quectel announces collaboration expansion with Future Electronics

Quectel Wireless Solutions has expanded its partnership with Future Electronics to distribute its complete IoT portfolio across Europe, the Middle East, and Africa. The agreement covers antennas, GNSS, Wi-Fi, Bluetooth, and smart modules, giving customers broader access to IoT technologies, technical support, and value-added services while strengthening supply chain resilience and market reach.

Nissan unit drops \$65 million UK EV investment plan

Nissan's transmission subsidiary, Jatco, has reportedly scrapped plans for a \$65 million EV powertrain plant in Sunderland, UK. The facility was expected to produce up to 340,000 integrated powertrain units annually. The decision reflects slower EV demand in Europe, Nissan's broader restructuring efforts, and increasing caution around EV manufacturing investments.

EU auto industry seeks further delay to Brexit EV tariffs

EU and UK automotive industry groups are seeking another delay to Brexit-related EV tariffs, warning regional battery production remains far below targets required from January 2027. With less than 20% of EV batteries expected to be produced locally by then, manufacturers cite supply-chain challenges, high costs, and raw-material constraints, raising concerns over competitiveness and investment.